Final EE Unit of Instruction: Should Grizzly Bears Return to California?

Gabriela Davidson

Env S 127A

6-1-2026

Unit Overview

The goal of this unit is to help upper elementary and middle school students (grades 4 to 6) investigate one of the most fascinating contradictions in their own state: California put a grizzly bear on its flag, made it the official state animal, and then wiped it out completely. Over the span of five lessons, students will move from simply noticing that absence to understanding the science behind it, wrestling with how people feel about it, building the skills to read a real law about it, and finally taking part in a real decision happening in their lifetime. The anchor for the whole unit is California SB 1305, the California Grizzly Restoration Act, a real bill introduced in 2026 that asks the state to study whether the grizzly could ever come home.

A second thread runs through the whole unit: Traditional Ecological Knowledge, or TEK, the deep, tested knowledge that California's Native nations have built over thousands of years of living with and caring for this land. The unit grounds TEK in the two tribes that actually co-sponsored SB 1305, the Yurok Tribe of the far north along the Klamath and Trinity rivers, and the Tejon Indian Tribe of the southern San Joaquin Valley and Tehachapi Mountains, whose ancestral territories overlap the grizzly's historic range and the areas any return would consider. Students will learn that these were never empty wilderness, but lands actively tended by specific peoples, that the grizzly was a relative and not just an animal, and that the Yurok have already led the real, successful return of another locally extinct sacred species, the California condor, to their own territory.

This unit is built so that students never sit in despair about extinction. Extinction is the problem they inherit, but designing coexistence is the work they get to do. By the end, students will see themselves not as helpless witnesses but as people who can reason about evidence, listen across disagreement, respect more than one way of knowing, and contribute to how their community shares the land with wildlife.

My unit will consist of five lessons that build off one another as the days progress. It begins with Lesson One: The Bear on the Flag, which addresses the first objective of the Tbilisi Declaration, Awareness. Students meet the paradox of a state animal that no longer lives here, share their own encounters with wild animals, and observe the grizzly closely enough to start asking real questions. The next day, students engage with Lesson Two: Webs, Not Lists, which addresses the second Tbilisi objective, Knowledge. Through a structure to function activity called Build A Bear, a hands-on yarn ecosystem web, and an introduction to Traditional Ecological Knowledge, students learn how feeding relationships connect every living thing, what a keystone species does, and that there is more than one way to know an ecosystem. Lesson Three: When the Bear Vanished addresses the third Tbilisi objective, Attitudes, because tracing the human story of the grizzly's disappearance, including the displacement of Native nations and the banning of their land care, changes how students feel about the choices people make about wildlife. Then comes the most analytical lesson of the unit, Lesson Four: Who Gets a Say? SB 1305 and Coexistence Design, which addresses the fourth Tbilisi objective, Skills, by giving students hands-on practice reading a real law, weighing both Western science and TEK as evidence, and designing a workable coexistence plan. To finish the unit, students experience Lesson Five: Bears in My Backyard, which completes the final Tbilisi objective, Participation, by carrying everything back to the students' own community. They investigate local wildlife, learn whose ancestral land their school sits on, and produce a real class statement or letter about a real decision. Ultimately, this unit covers every objective of the Tbilisi Declaration, and its wide range of storytelling, hands-on building, movement, reading, and creating ensures that all four learning styles are able to engage.

The three lesson plans I am showcasing in full are Lesson One (Awareness), Lesson Two (Knowledge), and Lesson Four (Skills). All five plans are written out below, and the three showcased lessons are marked.

Lesson Plan #1: AWARENESS (SHOWCASED)

Lesson Plan Topic: The Bear on the Flag (noticing a missing state animal)

Instructor(s): Me / Teacher

Student / Audience Description: Grades 4 to 6

Amount of Time for the Lesson: 50 to 60 minutes

Management Considerations

1. Management

a. The class begins and ends seated in a circle, so set the room up before students arrive.

b. Have the projector ready with the grizzly photo and the California state flag, a basket of "Notice and Wonder" slips, and a talking piece (a smooth stone, a small carved bear, or any object that is comfortable to hold and pass).

2. Safety

a. The brief history of how grizzlies were killed can be hard for animal-loving students. Keep it factual and age-appropriate, name that it makes many people sad, and let students know it is okay to feel that way. Avoid graphic detail.

Materials

1. A large, high-quality photograph of a grizzly bear, projected
2. An image of the California state flag
3. A talking piece for the circle
4. Pre-cut "Notice and Wonder" slips, one per student
5. Chart paper and markers
6. Optional: a printed map showing the historical range of grizzlies in California

Curriculum Goal

Students will gain awareness of a powerful contradiction in their own state, that California honors the grizzly bear as its official state animal while having eliminated it from the landscape by the early 1920s. Through close observation and personal storytelling, students will begin to see that noticing what is missing from a place is the first step in understanding how that place works and how people shape it.

Learning Objectives

Through a circle discussion and guided observation, students will be able to describe the "flag paradox" and explain why a missing species matters.

Cognitive Objectives

1. Students will recall that the grizzly bear is California's state animal and was eliminated from the state by the early 1920s.
2. Students will describe, in their own words, the contradiction between honoring the grizzly on the flag and removing it from the land.
3. Students will explain why noticing a missing species matters for understanding a place.

Affective Objectives

1. Students will feel a personal connection to wild animals by recalling and sharing their own encounters.
2. Students will feel genuine wonder, and possibly sadness, about an animal that is absent from their home state, while staying hopeful that people can make different choices today.

Assessment(s)

1. Students will be assessed on their participation in the circle discussion using a simple participation checklist.
2. Students will complete a "Notice and Wonder" exit slip, writing one thing they noticed and one thing they wonder about the grizzly's disappearance. These slips are collected and used to launch Lesson Two.
3. As a short reflection, students will write three to four sentences answering: "If the grizzly is on our flag but not in our state, what does that tell us about how people treat nature?"

Procedure

1. East

a. Project the grizzly photograph at full size and let the class look at it in silence for thirty seconds. No talking, no instructions, just looking.

b. Tell the class a short, true story to spark a connection. Ie: "Over a hundred years ago, in 1889, a newspaper sent a man named Allen Kelly into the mountains of Southern California with one job: capture a living grizzly bear. He finally caught one and named him Monarch. Monarch lived the rest of his life behind bars in San Francisco, and people came from all over to see the last famous California grizzly. When artists later designed the bear on our state flag, they looked at pictures of Monarch. So the bear on our flag is a real bear, who lived in a cage, long after his wild relatives were gone."

c. Ask: "How does it feel to know that the bear on our flag was a real animal who lived in a cage?" Let a few students respond to warm up.

2. Southeast

a. Bring the class into the circle and introduce the talking piece and the norm: whoever holds it may speak or pass, and everyone else listens.

b. Pose the warm-up question and pass the piece around the circle: "Have you ever seen a wild animal somewhere unexpected? What did it feel like?" Note: some students have no outdoor wildlife memories, so explicitly offer, "It can also be an animal you saw in a video, a book, or online." No student should be excluded based on where they live or what they have access to.

c. After the circle, reveal the state flag beside the grizzly photo and ask, "What animal is this? Where else have you seen this bear?" Surfaces that students see on the flag, license plates, sports teams, and signs every day.

3. South

a. Share the core facts in a short, clear way, pausing for reactions: the grizzly is California's official state animal; around the time of the Gold Rush, roughly ten thousand grizzlies lived in California; for thousands of years before that, Native nations lived alongside the grizzly and many considered it a relative; as settlers, miners, and ranchers arrived, grizzlies were hunted, trapped, and killed for bounties; the last wild California grizzly was killed in 1922, and none were seen again after about 1924; California still kept the grizzly as its state animal and on its flag.

b. Guide a close observation of the photo: "What do you notice about this animal's body? Look at the shoulders, the claws, the size." "Why do you think ranchers might have wanted grizzlies gone?" "What would you be afraid of, and what would amaze you?"

4. Southwest

a. Take a thirty-second movement break. Students stand and do a slow "bear walk" stretch, reaching up tall like a standing bear, then down on all fours.

5. West

a. Have students turn to a partner and make a quick two-column list: "What we now know" and "What we wonder."

b. Invite a few pairs to share, and capture items on chart paper so the class can watch its knowledge and questions grow.

6. Northwest

a. Pose the central reflection question and let it breathe: "California kept the grizzly on its flag after killing the last one. What does that tell us about how people relate to nature?"

b. Resist resolving it. Let students sit in the tension and explore their different answers.

7. North

a. Connect to students' own lives: "Are there any animals that have disappeared from where you live? Are any coming back?" This plants the seed for Lesson Five.

b. End on an empowering note: extinction was a choice people made, which means living differently with wildlife is also a choice people can make.

8. Northeast

a. Have each student complete the "Notice and Wonder" exit slip on the way out.

b. Post the driving question on the wall for the week: "Should grizzly bears return to California?"

c. Tell students that tomorrow they will become the ecosystem itself and learn that there is more than one way to know how nature works.

Addressing All 4 Learning Styles

Type I: The story of Monarch and the circle question about personal wildlife encounters lets students make an emotional, personal connection to the topic before any facts arrive.

Type II: The South phase delivers concrete facts and dates: the state animal, the Gold Rush population estimate, the 1922 date, and the flag history.

Type III: Students observe real anatomy in the photo and sort what they know from what they wonder, connecting an abstract idea to a concrete, observable animal.

Type IV: The open-ended reflection question and the closing "what disappeared near you?" prompt push students to extend the idea on their own.

Lesson Plan #2: KNOWLEDGE (SHOWCASED)

Lesson Plan Topic: Webs, Not Lists (structure to function, food webs, and an introduction to Traditional Ecological Knowledge)

Instructor(s): Me / Teacher

Student / Audience Description: Grades 4 to 6

Amount of Time for the Lesson: 70 to 85 minutes (can be split across two shorter sessions)

Management Considerations

1. Management

a. This lesson has several moving parts: a small group activity, a whole class yarn web that needs open floor, a short introduction to TEK, and a movement game. Clear a large open space or plan to use the gym or yard.

b. Pre-sort the feature cards into group sets and have the species role cards, the TEK info cards, and the ball of yarn ready.

2. Safety

a. The yarn web requires a firm rule: hold your string taut, never yank it or wrap it around your neck or wrists.

b. For the tag game, set clear boundaries and a gentle two-finger "safe tag." Keep rounds short to prevent collisions.

c. Respect note for TEK: Traditional Ecological Knowledge belongs to specific Native nations. Teach it from real tribal sources or, when possible, invite a tribal educator. Present the examples as real, documented practices of the Yurok and Tejon, and never present TEK as a single generic "Native" belief.

Materials

1. Feature cards describing grizzly traits: long front claws, shoulder hump muscle, powerful jaws and teeth, thick fur, an excellent sense of smell, large body size, salmon fishing ability, and digging ability
2. One ball of yarn
3. Species role cards: grizzly bear, salmon, berries, oak and acorns, deer, ground squirrels, wildflowers, soil, insects, salmon carcass nutrients, and people
4. TEK info cards grounded in the two SB 1305 co-sponsor tribes: the Yurok condor and salmon restoration in the far north, and the Tejon Indian Tribe's oak woodland homeland in the south, plus the shared practice of cultural fire
5. Chart paper and markers
6. Open floor space for the web and the game

Curriculum Goal

Students will build a working understanding that an ecosystem is a web of relationships, not a list of separate animals. They will learn how a grizzly's body structures help it survive, what a keystone species is, how adding or removing one species sends changes rippling through the entire system, and that Western science is not the only way to know an ecosystem, because Traditional Ecological Knowledge has studied these same webs for thousands of years.

Learning Objectives

Through Build A Bear, a hands-on ecosystem web, and an introduction to TEK, students will be able to connect a structure to its function, predict what changes when a keystone species is added or removed, and explain in simple terms what Traditional Ecological Knowledge is.

Cognitive Objectives

1. Students will identify at least three grizzly structures and the function each one serves.

2. Students will construct an evidence-based claim that links a structure to its function and to the bear's survival (structure leads to function leads to survival). This aligns with NGSS 4-LS1-1.
3. Students will define "keystone species" and explain the grizzly's keystone role.
4. Students will model feeding relationships in a food web and predict at least three changes when the grizzly returns to it.
5. Students will explain, in their own words, what Traditional Ecological Knowledge is and give one example from the Yurok or Tejon tribes.

Affective Objectives

1. Students will feel a sense of awe at how interconnected living things are once they are literally holding the web in their hands.
2. Students will feel respect for Traditional Ecological Knowledge as a real and valuable way of understanding nature.
3. Students will feel comfortable naming an uncertainty out loud, understanding that real scientists name their uncertainties, too.

Assessment(s)

1. Each group will be assessed on its Build-A-Bear claim card using a short rubric that looks for clear structure, function, and survival reasoning.
2. Each student will record three predicted changes and one named uncertainty about what happens when the grizzly is added to the web. A photo of the finished web is kept for the unit portfolio.
3. Students will complete an exit ticket with two parts: a one-sentence definition of a keystone species with one example, and a one-sentence explanation of what TEK is with one example from the Yurok or Tejon.

Procedure

1. East

a. Open with a striking close-up of grizzly claws and the shoulder hump and say, "Every single part of this bear exists for a reason. Today we are going to figure out what those reasons are, then we are going to become a whole ecosystem, and then we are going to learn that there is more than one way to know how that ecosystem works."

2. Southeast

a. Run a quick Think, Pair, Share on "What do animals need to survive?" Record answers on chart paper (food, water, shelter, space, a way to raise young).

b. Then ask the prediction question and record it to revisit: "What might change if a large predator returned to a place after a hundred years?"

3. South (Activity 1: Build A Bear)

a. Put students in groups of three or four and give each group the full set of feature cards.

b. Explain the task: pick the three structures you think matter most for a grizzly surviving in California, and build a claim in this form, "This structure does this function, which helps the bear survive by doing this."

c. Emphasize that there is no single right answer. Groups must defend their three choices with reasoning. Ie: "Long front claws (structure) let the bear dig up roots, rodents, and dens (function), which helps it survive by reaching food other animals cannot get (survival)."

d. Have each group share its three structures and its strongest claim. Push gently with "How do you know?"

4. South (Activity 2: The Ecosystem Web)

a. Bring the class into a large circle and give each student a species role card.

b. Phase 1: Hand the ball of yarn to one student, who names a species they depend on, or that depends on them, holds their end, and passes the ball to that species. Continue until everyone is connected in one giant web. Have students gently tug their strings and watch the whole web move. Say, "That tangle in your hands is an ecosystem. It is a web of relationships, not a list."

c. Phase 2: "The grizzly has returned to California after a hundred years." Add the grizzly into the web and teach the key science in kid-friendly terms. Keystone species: a species that has a huge effect on its whole ecosystem, even if there are not many of them; remove it and the web rearranges. How the grizzly is a keystone species: it spreads berry seeds in its scat, churns and airs out the soil while digging, and drags salmon up onto the land, where the leftover carcasses fertilize the forest; this is why SB 1305 itself calls the grizzly a keystone species. Trophic cascade: when wolves returned to Yellowstone in 1995, they changed where elk grazed, which let trees grow back along rivers, which brought back beavers and birds. One returning predator reshaped the whole landscape.

d. Have each student write down three changes they predict for the web now that the grizzly is back, plus one thing they are genuinely uncertain about.

5. South (Activity 3: Two Ways of Knowing, an introduction to TEK)

a. Point to the "people" card in the web and ask, "Were the people in this web just watching, or were they part of it?" Reveal that for thousands of years, the Native nations of California were active members of the web, shaping it on purpose.

b. Introduce the term clearly and simply: "Traditional Ecological Knowledge, or TEK, is the knowledge about nature that Native peoples have built up over thousands of years of living with, watching, and caring for the land, and then passing what they learn down through the generations. TEK is real science. It comes from careful observation and testing over a very, very long time. It is just gathered differently from a science lab."

c. Share TEK with real, local examples from the two tribes that actually co-sponsored SB 1305:

i. The Yurok Tribe (far northern California, along the Klamath and Trinity rivers): the Yurok have cared for salmon for thousands of years and today lead major salmon and river restoration. They also led the return of prey-go-neesh, the California condor, a sacred bird that had been gone from their region for over a century. The Yurok released the first condors back into their ancestral territory in 2022. This is a real example of a tribe bringing a locally extinct animal home.

ii. The Tejon Indian Tribe (southern San Joaquin Valley and Tehachapi Mountains): their ancestral homeland is oak woodland and mountain country, where tending oaks for acorns supported people, deer, and bears alike, and which is still important habitat for the condor today.

iii. A practice shared by many California tribes, including in these regions, is cultural fire: gentle, planned burning that keeps forests and meadows healthy and helps prevent the huge, dangerous wildfires we see now.

iv. Respect note for the teacher: TEK belongs to specific nations. Name the Yurok and Tejon as the real tribes here, use their own words and websites where you can, and if possible, invite a tribal educator. Do not blend distinct nations into one generic "Native" example.

d. Tie it back to the web and the unit's big question: "Western science and TEK are two different ways of studying this same web, and when California asks whether the grizzly should come back, the law says we listen to both. In fact, the Yurok have already brought back a species everyone thought was gone for good. So our question is not impossible. It has been done."

6. Southwest (The Game)

a. Play Bear, Salmon, Mosquito, a food web version of rock-paper-scissors tag. Bear eats Salmon, Salmon eats mosquito larvae, Mosquito bothers Bear.

b. Split into two teams. Each team huddles and secretly picks an animal. On three, both teams reveal with an action and a sound. The winning animal chases the losing team toward a safe line, and anyone tagged joins the winning team. Play five to eight quick rounds.

7. West

a. Debrief the game into food web language: "Even the mosquito mattered. In a real web, the small things and the big things are all connected." Have groups post their web observations on the wall.

8. Northwest

a. Reflect as a class: "What surprised you about the web? Where were you the most uncertain? What did it feel like to learn that people were part of the web all along?" Validate uncertainty as part of doing real science.

9. North

a. Ask, "Where do you see webs like this near your home or your school? Who took care of the land where our school is, long before it was a school?" Help students connect the web and TEK to their own neighborhood.

10. Northeast

a. Collect the two-part exit ticket.

b. Set up tomorrow with a hook: "If one bear can do all of this work, and if people once helped take care of the whole web, then here is tomorrow's question. What happened when both the bear and that care were taken away?"

Addressing All 4 Learning Styles

Type I: The opening question, "What do animals need to survive?" and the reveal that people were part of the web connect directly to students' own needs and sense of belonging.

Type II: The lesson is rich with content: structure and function reasoning, the definition of a keystone species, the trophic cascade example from Yellowstone, and a clear definition of TEK with real Yurok and Tejon examples.

Type III: Students physically build the yarn web, construct evidence-based claims with the feature cards, and sort real TEK practice cards, turning abstract ideas into something they can hold.

Type IV: Phase 2 of the web and the "two ways of knowing" idea invite students to make predictions, compare different kinds of knowledge, and explore open-ended possibilities.

Lesson Plan #3: ATTITUDES

Lesson Plan Topic: When the Bear Vanished (the human story of extinction, the loss of Native land care, and what the web lost)

Instructor(s): Me / Teacher

Student / Audience Description: Grades 4 to 6

Amount of Time for the Lesson: 60 to 70 minutes

Management Considerations

1. Management

a. The center of this lesson is a class timeline built on a long strip of paper or a stretch of wall, so prepare the blank timeline and pre-cut event cards before class.

b. Have the historical range map from Lesson One ready, along with the species cards and the TEK info cards from Lesson Two.

2. Safety

a. The story of how grizzlies were killed, and the story of Native peoples being forced off their land and stopped from caring for it, can be upsetting. Keep it factual and free of graphic detail, name out loud that it makes a lot of people sad, and make space for those feelings.

b. Be careful that no student leaves feeling personally guilty. The goal is to understand systems and a moment in history, not to assign blame to children or their families.

c. Continue the TEK respect note: present Native land care as the real, documented practice of specific nations and, when possible, draw on actual tribal sources or a tribal educator.

Materials

1. A long blank timeline (butcher paper or a wall strip)
2. Event cards for the timeline (described in the procedure)
3. The historical range map of California grizzlies
4. The species role cards and TEK info cards from Lesson Two

5. A short read-aloud narrative about the last California grizzly
6. Sticky notes and reflection journals

Curriculum Goal

Students will understand the human story behind the grizzly's disappearance, including how the removal of Native peoples and the banning of their land care were part of that story, and use that understanding to form their own values and feelings about how people make decisions about wildlife and land.

Learning Objectives

Through building a class timeline and modeling what the ecosystem lost, students will be able to explain why grizzlies disappeared, connect that loss to the disruption of Native land care, and express a reasoned feeling about those choices.

Cognitive Objectives

1. Students will sequence the major events that led to the grizzly's extinction in California, including long-term Indigenous stewardship, the missions, the Gold Rush, bounties, ranching, and the banning of cultural fire.
2. Students will explain at least two ecosystem changes (a trophic cascade) that likely followed the grizzly's removal, and one change that followed the loss of Native land care.
3. Students will distinguish between blaming individual people and understanding the larger systems and pressures of a historical moment.

Affective Objectives

1. Students will feel empathy for the grizzly, for the Native nations whose land care was disrupted, and for the people who lived alongside and feared the bear.
2. Students will form and express their own values about how people should make decisions about wildlife and land.

Assessment(s)

1. Students will be assessed on the accuracy of the class timeline they help build.
2. Students will complete a "What the web lost" exit slip naming two cascade effects of the grizzly's removal, one effect of the loss of Native land care, and one sentence about how it makes them feel.
3. Students will choose one short reflective letter to write: a letter to the last California grizzly, a letter to a rancher living in California in the early 1900s, or a letter to a California legislator today.

Procedure

1. East

a. Begin with a short, vivid, non-graphic read-aloud that sets the scene. Ie: "Imagine California two hundred years ago. Salmon so thick in the rivers you could almost walk across on their backs. Oak forests, tended for generations by Native nations, drop acorns by the ton. Meadows kept open and healthy by a gentle fire. And moving through all of it, the largest animal in the state, the grizzly, fishing the rivers, digging the meadows, and shaping the land just by living in it. There were about ten thousand bears. Within the lifetime of one person, almost all of that changed."

2. Southeast

a. Bring back the yarn web image from Lesson Two and remind students that the web held together because every thread was connected, and that people were one of those threads.

b. Ask the hook: "Yesterday, we learned that the bear and the people both helped hold the web together. Today, we find out what happened when history pulled both of those threads out. Why did the bears disappear?"

3. South

a. Build the class timeline together. Hand out the event cards and have students place them in order on the wall, discussing the why at each step. Keep returning to pressures and systems rather than villains.

i. For thousands of years, California's Native nations, including the ancestors of today's Yurok and Tejon tribes, have lived with and stewarded the land, including the grizzly, using cultural fire, oak and acorn tending, and salmon stewardship.

ii. 1769 onward: Spanish missions arrive, Native peoples are displaced, and cattle ranching begins to change the landscape.

iii. 1848: The Gold Rush brings a sudden flood of newcomers, guns, and livestock.

iv. 1853: The Sebastian, or Tejon, Indian Reservation, the first Indian reservation in California, is created on lands that become Tejon Ranch, and people are pushed off their homelands.

v. 1850s onward: state policies and violence force Native nations off much of their land, and laws begin to ban the cultural fire that kept the web healthy.

vi. 1850s to early 1900s: grizzlies are hunted, trapped, and killed for bounties, partly out of fear and partly to protect cattle and sheep.

vii. 1889: Monarch, a wild grizzly, is captured and put on display.

viii. 1922: The last wild California grizzly is killed.

ix. 1924: the last reported grizzly sighting, after which none are ever confirmed again.

x. 1953: California names the grizzly its official state animal, decades after the last one is gone.

xi. 2008 to 2022: the Yurok Tribe leads the return of prey-go-neesh, the California condor, to its ancestral territory, showing that a locally extinct animal can be brought home.

xii. 2026: SB 1305 asks whether the grizzly could return, and is co-sponsored by the Yurok and Tejon tribes.

b. At each step, ask "Why did people do this?" Draw out real reasons: fear, protecting livelihoods, bounty money, government policies, and a time when there was no wildlife science, and Native knowledge was pushed aside.

4. Southwest

a. Have one quiet minute looking at the historical range map. The green shows everywhere grizzlies used to live. Let students take in how much of the state that covers, and that it is now empty of grizzlies.

5. West

a. Run the "What the web lost" model. Using the Lesson Two species and TEK cards, remove the grizzly and remove Native land care, then trace the ripple effects together: fewer berry seeds get spread, fewer salmon carcasses get carried inland, so the forest loses some of its natural fertilizer, the soil is dug and aerated less, and without cultural fire, brush builds up and the dangerous wildfires we see today become more likely.

b. Be honest about uncertainty. Scientists cannot prove every effect, so students should practice saying "we think this probably happened, but we are not certain."

6. Northwest

a. Lead a careful reflection: "Whose fault was this? Is fault even the right question?" Help students separate judging a hungry rancher in 1880, who had little information and few choices, from understanding the systems of bounties, removal, and banned land care that drove the loss.

b. Let students voice complicated feelings. Empathy for the bear, for the Native nations, and for ordinary people is all allowed. Help students see that the same era that erased the grizzly also displaced these specific tribes and outlawed the land care that kept the web healthy, so the bear and the people lost ground at the same time, and that today some of those same tribes are leading the way back.

7. North

a. Bridge to today: "We know far more now than people did then, and today people are listening to Native knowledge again. Does knowing more change what we owe wildlife and the land? Does it change what we are responsible for?"

8. Northeast

a. Have each student write their chosen reflective letter and complete the "What the web lost" exit slip.

b. Preview Lesson Four: "Now that we understand how the grizzly was lost, the big question is who gets to decide whether it comes back, and how, and whose knowledge counts."

Addressing All 4 Learning Styles

Type I: The read-aloud and the choice of a personal letter let first learners connect emotionally to the bear, the land, and the people in the story.

Type II: The timeline and the cascade model give fact-oriented learners a clear sequence of events and concrete ecological consequences to study.

Type III: Students physically build the timeline and trace the cascade with the species and TEK cards, turning history and ecology into something hands-on.

Type IV: The open question "Is fault even the right question?" and the free choice of who to write to invite dynamic learners to form and extend their own ideas.

Lesson Plan #4: SKILLS (SHOWCASED)

Lesson Plan Topic: Who Gets a Say? SB 1305 and Coexistence Design

Instructor(s): Me / Teacher

Student / Audience Description: Grades 4 to 6

Amount of Time for the Lesson: 75 to 90 minutes (can be split across two sessions)

Management Considerations

1. Management

a. Begin and end as a whole group, but do the core work in groups of three or four. Reserve wall space for posting plans.

b. Pre-teach four vocabulary words before the reading: consultation, ancestral territory, peer review, and Traditional Ecological Knowledge (review from Lesson Two). Have a glossary and sentence frames ready, so the legislative text is accessible to every reader.

2. Safety

a. The perspective work touches real people's livelihoods and real tribal nations. Set the rule clearly: students represent viewpoints, they do not make fun of people. Handle tribal perspectives with particular care by grounding them in the real Yurok and Tejon co-sponsorship rather than in invented stereotypes.

Materials

1. A simplified, grade-appropriate one-page excerpt of SB 1305 listing its roadmap requirements (see Background Information)
2. Highlighters and pencils
3. Poster paper and markers
4. Sticky notes
5. Reflection journals
6. Perspective role cards: rancher, tribal elder, wildlife biologist, and town resident

Curriculum Goal

Students will gain the skills to read a real law, find the decisions hidden inside it, support a claim with textual evidence, weigh both Western science and Traditional Ecological Knowledge as valid evidence, and design a coexistence plan that fairly balances the needs of wildlife, ranchers, tribal nations, and residents. They will practice listening across genuine disagreement.

Learning Objectives

Through annotating a real bill and designing a coexistence plan, students will be able to analyze who gets a say in a decision, evaluate which requirement does the most for ecosystems, people, and justice, and write a reasoned position that draws on more than one kind of evidence.

Cognitive Objectives

1. Students will summarize what SB 1305 requires before any grizzly could be reintroduced.

2. Students will analyze the bill excerpt to identify who gets a say, what has to happen first, and who might be left out.
3. Students will evaluate which requirement does the most for ecosystems, the most for people, and the most for justice, using evidence from the actual text.
4. Students will design a community coexistence plan that balances wildlife, ranchers, tribes, and residents.

Affective Objectives

1. Students will value tribal sovereignty and the inclusion of Traditional Ecological Knowledge and cultural and spiritual values as a real part of an environmental decision.
2. Students will respond to disagreement with empathy by imagining how a rancher, a tribal elder, and a wildlife biologist would each react to their plan.

Assessment(s)

1. Students will be assessed on their annotated bill excerpt, looking for markings that flag decisions, voices, and who might be left out.
2. Groups will be assessed on their "most for ecosystems, people, and justice" claims, scored on the use of direct evidence from the text.
3. Groups will present a coexistence plan poster with a two-minute share-out, assessed on how well it balances competing needs.
4. As the closing transfer task, students will write for three to five minutes on the unit's driving question: "Should grizzlies return to California? Use science evidence, Traditional Ecological Knowledge, human impacts, and fairness."

Procedure

1. East

a. Open with a real headline: "In 2026, California wrote a real law about bringing grizzly bears back. It is called SB 1305, the California Grizzly Restoration Act." Let students react to the fact that this is happening right now.

2. Southeast

a. Recall Lesson Two: "If a grizzly does all that work for an ecosystem, should it come back?" Take a silent hands vote, and hold the result without resolving it, because that tension is the whole point of today.

b. Frame the reading: "You are not just reading for information today. You are reading for decisions. As you read, look for who gets a say, what has to happen first, and who might be left out."

c. Name the real tribes: "The two tribes that helped write this law are the Yurok in the far north and the Tejon in the south. The Yurok have already brought back the condor. Why might California especially want to listen to a tribe that has already led a real reintroduction?"

d. Add one more layer for stronger groups: "The newest version of the law asks a tricky question. It not only asks whether we should bring the bears back. It also asks, could we get back what the bears used to do for the land, even without the bears. What do you think that means, and is that a fair compromise or a cop out?"

3. South (The SB 1305 Roadmap Lab)

a. Hand out the simplified bill excerpt, read it together once, then have groups annotate it: underline every decision, circle every group of people who get a say, and put a star next to anyone who might be left out.

b. The excerpt should make clear that the bill does not release bears tomorrow. In the amended Senate version dated April 16, 2026, it requires the Department of Fish and Wildlife to build a roadmap first, and that roadmap does more than plan a reintroduction. It evaluates whether, and under what conditions, bringing the grizzly back would be both feasible and advisable, and it also studies how much of the ecological work the grizzly once did could be restored through human-guided landscape restoration, with or without actually returning live bears. The roadmap must include:

i. A scientific assessment using the best available data, including habitat suitability and population modeling.

ii. Consultation with California Native American tribes, with priority given to tribes whose ancestral territories are involved.

iii. An independent peer review that includes tribal representatives.

iv. A cultural and spiritual values framework, which is one way the law makes room for Traditional Ecological Knowledge from the Yurok, Tejon, and other tribes.

v. Human and wildlife coexistence standards and a way to compensate ranchers for any livestock losses.

The department must submit the finished roadmap to the Legislature, the Legislative Analyst's Office, and the Fish and Game Commission by June 30, 2030. No grizzly can be reintroduced until the roadmap is complete and the science shows that a self-sustaining population would be biologically viable.

c. As a group, students decide which requirement does the most to protect ecosystems, which does the most to protect people, and which does the most for justice. They must back each answer with evidence from the actual text. Prompt them to notice that the law treats tribal knowledge as real evidence, not just opinion.

d. Each group then designs a coexistence plan on poster paper: a realistic plan for how grizzlies and people could share the land, addressing at least one need of wildlife, ranchers, tribes, and residents.

4. Southwest

a. Take a movement break. Partners walk and talk for two minutes about one thing their plan absolutely must protect.

5. West

a. Groups post their coexistence plans on the wall. Each group gives a two-minute share-out, answering: What did you create? What problem were you solving? How might a rancher, a tribal elder, or a wildlife biologist respond to your plan?

6. Northwest

a. Hold a silent gallery walk. Students read every other group's plan and leave one sticky note response on each, then journal for one minute about which plan changed their thinking.

7. North

a. Bring it local: "What wildlife conflicts or returns are happening near us, and who should get a say here?" This bridges directly into Lesson Five.

8. Northeast

a. Have students complete the three to five-minute position write on the driving question, using science evidence, Traditional Ecological Knowledge, human impacts, and fairness. Remind them there is no "right" side, only well-reasoned ones.

b. Preview Lesson Five: tomorrow, they take everything they have learned and apply it to their own backyard, and the class will create something real together.

Addressing All 4 Learning Styles

Type I: The opening vote and the framing question, "who gets a say and who is left out," make the issue personal and value-driven before any reading happens.

Type II: The actual requirements of the bill give fact-oriented learners authoritative, expert text to analyze.

Type III: Students annotate, build evidence-based claims, and design a working coexistence plan, applying their knowledge to a concrete, real-world problem.

Type IV: Designing the plan, imagining how different people would respond, and writing their own position essay are open-ended, generative tasks.

Lesson Plan #5: PARTICIPATION

Lesson Plan Topic: Bears in My Backyard (local wildlife, whose land we are on, and a real class action)

Instructor(s): Me / Teacher

Student / Audience Description: Grades 4 to 6

Amount of Time for the Lesson: 60 to 90 minutes

Management Considerations

1. Management

a. This lesson works best with a real-world connection. Plan one of three options ahead of time: a short guided walk around the schoolyard or neighborhood, a set of local wildlife stations in the classroom, or a visit from a local wildlife biologist, park ranger, naturalist, or tribal educator. A visit from a local tribal educator is the strongest option for the TEK thread, so reach out early if that is possible.

b. Look up whose ancestral land your school sits on ahead of time, using a reliable source such as a local tribe's own website, so you can share it accurately.

c. Have the class's accumulated work from Lessons One through Four on hand, along with materials for the final class product.

2. Safety

a. If you go outside, set buddy pairs and clear boundaries, and establish the rule that students observe wildlife and plants without touching them.

b. For any contact with a community member, official, or tribal educator, follow your school's communication policies and get the needed permissions in advance.

Materials

1. Local wildlife information sheets or field guide cards for your region
2. Examples of local human and wildlife interactions (coyotes, mountain lions, black bears, deer, returning species such as the California condor)
3. Accurate information about the Native nation or nations whose ancestral land your school is on
4. The class's work from the previous four lessons
5. Poster paper, markers, and letter-writing or shared document materials
6. Optional: a device for a virtual guest visit

Curriculum Goal

Students will apply everything they have learned to their own community and take a real, age-appropriate action. They will move from studying a decision happening far away to participating in how people and wildlife share their own local landscape, and they will learn whose land they live and learn on.

Learning Objectives

Through a local investigation and a shared class product, students will be able to connect the grizzly case to their own community, the name whose ancestral land their school is on, and take a concrete participatory action.

Cognitive Objectives

1. Students will identify wildlife that lives near their school and at least one local human and wildlife interaction or conflict.
2. Students will identify the Native nation or nations whose ancestral territory includes their community.
3. Students will compare the grizzly case to a local example of a wildlife return, conflict, or decision.
4. Students will co-create a public product, such as a class statement, a letter, or a coexistence guide, that communicates a reasoned position or proposal.

Affective Objectives

1. Students will feel a sense of agency, understanding that their voice and their choices matter in real decisions.

2. Students will feel connected to their own local place, the wildlife that shares it, and the people who have cared for it the longest.

Assessment(s)

1. Students will be assessed on a local wildlife investigation worksheet or map.
2. Students will be assessed on their contribution to the class product, looking at both participation and the quality of their reasoning.
3. Students will write a final reflection connecting their own action to the unit's driving question.

Procedure

1. East

a. Open with a local hook: "All week we have been a hundred years and hundreds of miles away. Today, the question comes home. What wild animals live right here, and whose land are we standing on?" Share, accurately, the Native nation or nations whose ancestral territory includes your school, and show a photo of a local species.

2. Southeast

a. Brainstorm and share: "What animals have you seen near your home or school? Has anything disappeared from our area? Is anything coming back?" Capture answers on chart paper. Students will likely name coyotes, deer, hawks, raccoons, and, in some regions, mountain lions, black bears, or the returning California condor.

3. South

a. Run the investigation using your chosen format. During a guided walk, station rotation, or guest visit, students gather three things: what wildlife lives here, what conflicts happen here (such as coyotes and pets, deer in gardens, or bears in trash), and what is returning here. Connect it to the Yurok condor story as a model of a tribe leading a real comeback, and have students find out which Native nation cares for the land their school sits on. If a tribal educator visits, invite them to share how Native land care shaped, and still shapes, this place.

b. Have students create a simple map of local wildlife, marking where different animals are found and where people and wildlife overlap.

4. Southwest

a. Take a short movement break. Have students act out a local animal's movement, or take a one-minute gratitude pause for a species that shares their neighborhood.

5. West

a. Connect the local example back to the grizzly. Ask the same justice questions from Lesson Four about a local decision: "Who gets a say in how we treat coyotes or mountain lions here? Whose knowledge should we listen to? Who benefits, and who carries the risk?"

6. Northwest

a. Reflect together: "What is one small, real thing our class could actually do?" Generate a list of options and let students react to each.

7. North

a. Build the class product. As a class, choose and create one real action. Options include: a class statement or set of letters about SB 1305 to send to a state legislator or to the Department of Fish and Wildlife; a coexistence guide for a local species, such as a "living with coyotes" handout for families; or a schoolyard wildlife awareness poster campaign that includes a respectful note about whose land the school is on.

b. Students draft the product together, using evidence and fairness, the way they practiced all week.

8. Northeast

a. Close the entire unit in a circle. Return to the driving question one last time, and have each student share a single sentence: "Should grizzlies return, and what will I do?"

b. Send, post, or deliver the class product so the action is real, then celebrate the work the class has done together.

Addressing All 4 Learning Styles

Type I: Investigating animals in their own neighborhood, learning whose land they are on, and choosing a real action give feeling first learners a strong personal and place-based connection.

Type II: The local wildlife information and the comparison between the grizzly case and a local example give fact-oriented learners concrete content to work with.

Type III: The hands-on investigation, the local map, and building a real product let practical learners apply everything they have learned.

Type IV: Choosing and creating the class action is an open-ended, generative task that lets dynamic learners take their learning out into the real world.

Cumulative Assessment

After completing the final lesson, students will choose one of the following assignments to complete over the following week:

1. Write a letter to a California legislator or to the Department of Fish and Wildlife sharing your reasoned position on whether grizzlies should return, using scientific evidence, Traditional Ecological Knowledge, human impacts, and fairness.
2. Create an illustrated children's book or comic that tells the story of the last California grizzly and the question of whether the bear could come home.
3. Design a full coexistence plan poster for one specific California region, showing how grizzlies, ranchers, tribes, and residents could share the land.
4. Map the wildlife that has disappeared from or returned to your own community, and write a one to two-page reflection on what you found and who gets a say in those changes.
5. Interview a family or community member about a wild animal they remember from your area, then write a short piece connecting their story to what you learned about the grizzly.

Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and/or Justice Considerations

Ways in which these lesson plans address these considerations:

1. The unit centers tribal sovereignty as a real part of the decision. SB 1305 is genuinely co-sponsored by the Yurok and Tejon tribes and gives priority to tribes whose ancestral territories are involved, so students learn that Indigenous knowledge and authority are formal parts of wildlife decisions, not an afterthought.
2. Traditional Ecological Knowledge is introduced directly to students and grounded in the real tribes connected to the bill rather than generic examples. The unit defines TEK in kid-friendly language and ties it to the Yurok Tribe's salmon and condor restoration in the north and the Tejon Indian Tribe's oak woodland homeland in the south, the two tribes that co-sponsored SB 1305, positioning TEK alongside Western science as a second valid way of knowing the same ecosystem.
3. Environmental justice is made concrete and age-appropriate through a clear triad: who decides, who benefits, and who carries the risk. Students examine how a decision can be made by legislators far from bear country while rural ranchers and residents carry the day-to-day risk, and how Native nations were once shut out and are now included.
4. The unit places the "blame" for extinction on historical choices and systems rather than on the students or their families. Students are inspired to use their own agency and are given real tools to do so, but they are never shamed or made to feel hopeless.

5. The teacher provides reading supports, including pre-taught vocabulary, a glossary, and sentence frames, so that the real legislative text in Lesson Four is accessible to every reader regardless of reading level.
6. The teacher offers no-cost and low-barrier ways to participate throughout, such as the "an animal you saw in a video or book" option in Lesson One, so that students without outdoor access or with limited resources are fully included.
7. The unit teaches TEK respectfully. It treats TEK as the property of specific Native nations rather than a generic "Native belief," draws on real and citable examples from the Yurok and Tejon, and encourages inviting a tribal educator and learning whose ancestral land the school sits on, so the unit teaches with Native knowledge rather than just about it.

Background Information

GENERAL INFORMATION. This unit asks students to sit with a striking contradiction in their own state and then to do something productive with it. California adopted the grizzly bear (Ursus arctos) as its official state animal in 1953, and the grizzly has appeared on the state flag for more than a century, yet the species was eliminated from California by the mid 1920s (Storer and Tevis, 1955). To teach this unit, an educator needs a basic grasp of the grizzly's natural history, the science of keystone species and food webs, the meaning of Traditional Ecological Knowledge, the contents and process of SB 1305, and the cultural significance of the bear to California's tribes. The sections below provide that background. The most important teaching stance is to keep the unit hopeful. The science and history are sobering, but the work students actually do, designing coexistence and forming reasoned positions, is forward-looking and empowering.

THE CALIFORNIA GRIZZLY AND HOW IT VANISHED. The grizzly is the largest brown bear, and large California males could exceed a thousand pounds before hibernation. Around the time of the Gold Rush, an estimated ten thousand grizzlies lived across the state (Storer and Tevis, 1955). Within a single human lifetime, settlement, mining, ranching, and organized bounty killing eliminated them. The last wild California grizzly is generally said to have been killed in Tulare County in 1922, with the last reported sighting around 1924, after which none were ever confirmed again. A famous individual named Monarch, captured in 1889 and held in San Francisco until he died in 1911, was the model for the bear later standardized on the state flag. The contradiction at the heart of this unit, that California memorialized the grizzly while erasing it, is exactly the productive tension teachers should let students explore rather than resolve too quickly.

KEYSTONE SPECIES, FOOD WEBS, AND TROPHIC CASCADES.

The scientific spine of the unit is the idea that ecosystems are webs of relationships rather than lists of species. A keystone species has an effect on its ecosystem that is large relative to its numbers, so that its removal causes the whole system to rearrange. Grizzlies functioned this way in California. They dispersed berry seeds in their scat, aerated soil while digging for roots and rodents, and moved ocean nutrients inland by carrying salmon carcasses into forests. SB 1305 itself describes the grizzly as a California keystone species (California State Legislature, 2026). A widely used teaching analogy is the return of wolves to Yellowstone National Park in 1995, which set off a trophic cascade that changed elk behavior, allowed streamside vegetation to recover, and reshaped the landscape (Ripple and Beschta, 2012). One honest nuance worth keeping in mind for older or curious students is that recent genomic research indicates California's historical grizzlies were not a genetically distinct subspecies but part of the broader North American grizzly population, which is part of why reintroduction is even biologically conceivable.

TRADITIONAL ECOLOGICAL KNOWLEDGE (TEK).

Traditional Ecological Knowledge is the body of knowledge, practice, and belief about the relationships between living things and their environment that Indigenous peoples have developed over thousands of years and passed down across generations. It is gathered through long, careful observation and hands-on management of the land, and it is increasingly recognized by scientists as a rigorous complement to Western science. In California, Native nations actively shaped the landscapes that early settlers mistook for untouched wilderness (Anderson, 2005). Documented practices include cultural fire, the deliberate use of frequent low-intensity burning to maintain meadows and reduce catastrophic wildfire; the tending of oak woodlands for acorns, a staple food; and the careful stewardship of salmon runs. Because TEK belongs to specific nations, this unit grounds it in the two tribes that co-sponsored SB 1305 rather than in a generic "Native" example, and the strongest version of the unit involves reaching out to those tribes' own materials or a tribal educator. Robin Wall Kimmerer's work is a helpful teacher resource for understanding TEK as a way of knowing that braids together with, rather than competes against, scientific knowledge (Kimmerer, 2013).

THE YUROK AND TEJON TRIBES AND THE CONDOR PRECEDENT.

SB 1305 is co-sponsored by the Yurok Tribe and the Tejon Indian Tribe, whose territories sit at the northern and southern ends of the grizzly's historic California range. The Yurok Tribe, along the Klamath and Trinity rivers in far northern California, has stewarded salmon for thousands of years and today leads major river and salmon restoration. The Yurok also led the Northern California Condor Restoration Program, a partnership with Redwood National and State Parks, and in 2022 ,they released the first prey-go-neesh, or California condors, back into their ancestral territory, returning a sacred bird that had been absent for more than a century (Yurok Tribe, 2024; U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, 2022). This is the single most useful real-world parallel for the unit: a SB 1305 co-sponsor tribe has already led a successful, science-based, culturally grounded return of a locally extinct species in its own homeland, which tells students that the grizzly question is not a fantasy. The Tejon Indian Tribe, made up of Kitanemuk, Yokuts, and Chumash people, has its ancestral homeland in the southern San Joaquin Valley and the San Emigdio and Tehachapi Mountains, oak woodland, and condor country. That region also holds a hard history: the Sebastian, or Tejon, Indian Reservation of 1853 was the first Indian reservation in California, established on lands that became the vast Tejon Ranch before the people were displaced. Teaching the grizzly's loss alongside these tribes' histories of displacement, survival, and leadership helps students see wildlife and justice as the same story.

SB 1305: THE CALIFORNIA GRIZZLY RESTORATION ACT.

SB 1305 is a real, active bill introduced in February 2026 by Senator Laura Richardson and co-authored by Senators Blakespear, Stern, and Weber Pierson. It is co-sponsored by the Yurok and Tejon tribes. The most important point for teaching is that the bill does not order bears released into the wild. It directs the California Department of Fish and Wildlife to develop a public roadmap. In the amended Senate version dated April 16, 2026, that roadmap evaluates whether, and under what conditions, reintroduction would be feasible and advisable, and it also examines how much of the ecological function the grizzly once provided could be restored through human-guided landscape restoration, not necessarily by returning live bears (California State Legislature, 2026). The amended version also removes the grizzly from the existing rules that treat bears as a huntable game animal. Reintroduction is prohibited until a list of conditions is met, including a science-based determination that a self-sustaining population would be biologically viable, completion of the roadmap, consultation with California Native American tribes, and community engagement. The bill's required cultural and spiritual values framework is one formal way that Traditional Ecological Knowledge is built into the decision. The amended bill moved the deadline for submitting the roadmap to the Legislature, the Legislative Analyst's Office, and the Fish and Game Commission to June 30, 2030. As of spring 2026, the bill was still moving through the Senate, with a hearing in the Natural Resources and Water Committee. Supporters frame it as ecological and cultural restoration aligned with the state's 30x30 biodiversity goal, while opponents, especially in rural Northern California, raise real concerns about human safety, livestock, and who carries the risk of a decision made elsewhere. Teachers should present both sides sincerely, because the disagreement is the content that makes the skills and attitude objectives authentic.

TRIBAL CONTEXT AND ENVIRONMENTAL JUSTICE.

For many California tribes, the grizzly is not a symbol but a relative, woven into story, ceremony, and stewardship of the land. The bill's explicit prioritization of ancestral territories and its cultural and spiritual values framework reflects a shift toward treating tribal nations as sovereign partners in wildlife decisions rather than as stakeholders to be informed afterward. The clearest, most citable example of this is the real co-sponsorship of SB 1305 by the Yurok and Tejon tribes, and the Yurok Tribe's leadership of the condor restoration. The environmental justice lens for students stays simple and powerful: who decides, who benefits, and who carries the risk. Educators should approach tribal content with humility, rely on tribes' own public statements, and avoid flattening many distinct nations into a single "Native perspective."

A NOTE ON TEACHING THIS WITHOUT DOOM.

Environmental education research and the Tbilisi Declaration itself both emphasize that fear and guilt are poor long-term motivators. This unit deliberately moves students from awareness through knowledge and attitudes and into skills and participation, so that by the end, they are not paralyzed by a sad story but equipped to think clearly and act. Keep returning to the line that frames the whole unit: extinction was a choice people made, which means a different relationship with wildlife is also a choice people can make.

Work Cited

Anderson, M. Kat. (2005). Tending the Wild: Native American Knowledge and the Management of California's Natural Resources. University of California Press.

California Department of Education. (n.d.). Curriculum Frameworks and Instructional Materials. https://www.cde.ca.gov/ci/

California Department of Fish and Wildlife. (n.d.). Grizzly Bear (Ursus arctos): Species Information. https://wildlife.ca.gov

California State Legislature. (2026). Senate Bill No. 1305, California Grizzly Restoration Act (2025 to 2026 Regular Session), Amended Senate version, April 16, 2026. California Legislative Information. https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov

Kimmerer, R. W. (2013). Braiding Sweetgrass: Indigenous Wisdom, Scientific Knowledge, and the Teachings of Plants. Milkweed Editions.

McCarthy, B. (1987). The 4MAT System: Teaching to Learning Styles with Right and Left Mode Techniques. About Learning, Inc.

NGSS Lead States. (2013). Next Generation Science Standards: For States, By States. National Academies Press. https://www.nextgenscience.org

Ripple, W. J., and Beschta, R. L. (2012). Trophic cascades in Yellowstone: The first 15 years after wolf reintroduction. Biological Conservation, 145(1), 205 to 213.

Storer, T. I., and Tevis, L. P. (1955). California Grizzly. University of California Press.

Tbilisi Declaration. (1977). Intergovernmental Conference on Environmental Education, Final Report. UNESCO and UNEP, Tbilisi, USSR.

U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service. (2022). California condor reintroduction in Northern California: A partnership with the Yurok Tribe. https://www.fws.gov

Young, J., Haas, E., and McGown, E. (2010). Coyote's Guide to Connecting with Nature (2nd ed.). OWLink Media.

Yurok Tribe. (2024). Yurok Condor Restoration Program and the Northern California Condor Restoration Program. https://www.yuroktribe.org/yurok-condor-restoration-program

---